

First day, 90 minutes

ONE CHANGE TO YOUR PLAN, AND WHY

You asked for the solo presentation first and the mingle after. This reverses them. At fourteen and fifteen the audience that matters is not you, it is the other four, and a peer audience is the most threatening one there is at that age. Asked to stand and speak in the first fifteen minutes they give you their shortest possible answer and sit down, and day one has taught them that speaking here is a risk. Mingling first is loud and pairwise, so by the time they stand up they have already spoken English to everyone in the room.

The authority signal does not come from exposure. It comes from every instruction given once, in English, with a time limit you enforce. The stand-up still happens, all five, no opt out. They are simply set up to succeed at it rather than freeze.

Also changed: the 40-word message on Level Ladder page 3 is now a fast-finisher only, since Task 3 is a better writing sample and 90 minutes will not hold both.

And presentations are one minute, not ninety seconds. The profile no longer asks for a secret either: a fourteen-year-old asked to reveal something private to four strangers says nothing or says too much. It now asks what surprises people about them, which they can answer at whatever depth they choose.

Run order

TIME	BLOCK	WHAT YOU DO
15:45 3 min	Open	Names on the board, yours included. Four rules, said once, in English, not negotiated: we speak English in this room, we use full sentences, phones in bags, everybody talks. Do not ask if they agree.
15:48 12 min	Find someone who page 1	Everybody stands, chairs pushed back. Demonstrate one question with the quietest-looking student so the first exchange is done for them. Enforce the rule that no name appears more than three times. Circulate and listen, do not correct. Stop it while it is still noisy.
16:00 8 min	About you page 2	Silent, seated, individual. Twelve short answers. Tell them nobody reads it. Walk round and help with vocabulary only.
16:08 7 min	Build six lines page 2	They turn their answers into the seven sentence frames, including the line that names a classmate. This is your writing sample, collect it at the end.
16:15 4 min	Rehearse in pairs	Each says all seven lines to one partner, partner gives one piece of advice, then swap. Nobody presents without having said it out loud once. At this age this step is what prevents the freeze.
16:19 11 min	Stand and deliver page 3	All five, standing, at the front. About one minute each, not more. Seven lines is roughly 45 seconds at this level, so close it while they are still talking. Listeners complete the grid. Two questions from the floor after each speaker. You go first, so the format is modelled. If someone dries up: ask one of three prepared questions instead of waiting. Where exactly in Valencia? What do you do at the weekend? Who taught you that? Never let the silence run.
16:30 5 min	Common ground page 3	Whole class, standing or in a circle. Three things true of all six of you, including you. Obvious answers rejected. They must agree out loud. Write the three on the board and leave them there.
16:35 30 min	Level Ladder	Seated, silent, individual. Hand out, explain in one sentence that it is not an exam and covers the whole year. Collect at the end.
17:05 8 min	Close	Hand back the First Day sheet, they write their December goal at the bottom, you collect it. Show them the book and tell them Unit 1 is Perfect for the job.

If you run late. Cut Common Ground to three minutes, or stop the Level Ladder at Part 4 and finish it next Wednesday. Never cut the stand-up or the rehearsal.

Who is confident, and who is not

HOW TO USE THIS

Fill it in during the stand-up, not afterwards. You are recording behaviour, not marking English. A student who speaks for 90 seconds in poor English is more use to you this year than one who says four perfect sentences and sits down. Quiet and unwilling need opposite treatment, so keep them apart in your notes.

During the presentations

STUDENT	1	2	3	4	5
Name					
How long they spoke					
Read every word, or looked up?					
Voice reached the back?					
Answered a question					
Asked someone a question					
Needed prompting					
Quiet, or unwilling?					

During the mingle, which is where the truth usually is

STUDENT	1	2	3	4	5
Started, or waited?					
Asked follow-ups					
Switched to Spanish when stuck					
Gravitated towards?					

Decide before you leave the room

Strongest speaker, and who to pair them with so they are not the class translator?	
Who spoke least, and the smallest thing they will definitely manage next Wednesday?	
Which two found something in common, and can that pairing carry into Unit 1?	
Anyone you need to sit apart?	

The seventh line is the one that builds the class. Every presentation ends by naming another student, so five presentations means five public connections between people who were strangers an hour earlier. Do not let anyone skip it.

Feeds into Unit 1. Task 2 questions 4, 5, 8 and 9 are present simple against continuous, personality adjectives and jobs, which is the Unit 1 syllabus produced by them before they open the book.